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Top Skills

Aircraft Integration
Aircraft Maintenance
Aircraft Systems

James Sampson

Lead Integration Technician | Fury Launch Team | Arsenal-1
Columbus, Ohio Metropolitan Area

Summary

Lead Integration Technician on the Fury Launch Team at Anduril Industries — one of the original seven tech hires at Arsenal-1, Anduril's $900M autonomous weapons manufacturing facility in Columbus, Ohio.

I serve as the designated ATP technician for the YFQ-44A Fury — having completed the full ATP cycle multiple times and authored Anduril's ATP technician training program. Arsenal-1 begins production this month, three months ahead of schedule.

Former U.S. Air Force NCO with 22+ years across military aviation, defense contracting, and commercial aerospace. I bring a leadership-first approach to production and integration — focused on predictable execution, mentoring the next generation of defense manufacturing technicians, and building teams that perform under real schedule pressure.

Long-term goal: production leadership and management at Arsenal-1 as it scales from 25 technicians today to 4,000 jobs by 2035. I want to help build that culture from the ground up.

Experience

Anduril Industries
1 year 1 month

Lead Integration Technician
June 2026 - Present (1 month)
Columbus, OH

Lead Integration Technician on the Fury Launch Team at Arsenal-1. Responsible for technician development, production quality standards, and ATP execution as Arsenal-1 scales toward full rate production.

Integration Technician
June 2025 - June 2026 (1 year 1 month)

Columbus, Ohio, United States

Designated ATP technician for the YFQ-44A Fury Collaborative Combat Aircraft

Author of Fury's ATP Technician Training Program

One of the original seven tech hires at Arsenal-1, Columbus, Ohio

NetJets

Maintenance Planning

2022 - September 2024 (2 years)

Managed long-term maintenance forecasting and planning across a fleet of Embraer Phenom 300 light jets and Cessna Citation Sovereign midsize jets at multiple base stations nationwide

Developed and published detailed work packages for scheduled inspections, coordinating aircraft availability, vendor capability, tooling, and man-hours to maximize inspection yield

Utilized MaintainX CMMS to create, manage, and track base maintenance plans aligned with FAA compliance requirements and operational schedules

Collaborated with engineering, operations, and MRO vendors to resolve inspection interval discrepancies and coordinate aircraft improvements

Analyzed maintenance data to identify cost reduction opportunities and optimize inspection intervals across the fleet

General Dynamics Information Technology

Electrical Technician

2018 - 2020 (2 years)

New Bern, North Carolina, United States

Built and assembled aircraft wiring harnesses for UH-60 Black Hawk and CH-47 Chinook military helicopters in a production cable shop environment

Fabricated, routed, and terminated multi-conductor cable assemblies to military specifications and engineering drawings

Performed quality inspections on completed harness assemblies prior to aircraft installation

Supported depot-level maintenance and modification programs for U.S. Army rotary wing platforms

US Navy

Aircraft Electrician

2014 - 2018 (4 years)

DoW civil service. MV-22 Osprey, Fleet Readiness Center East, Marine Corps Air Station Cherry Point, NC with a 3-month temporary duty assignment at

Hurlburt Field AFB supporting ISO maintenance on CV-22 Osprey special operations aircraft
First two years focused on wiring overhaul. Full electrical system teardown, repair, and rebuild to depot-level standards
Final two years transitioned to preflight testing and flight operations support, ensuring aircraft electrical systems were mission-ready prior to flight
Achieved significant process improvement on the mid-wing wiring modification for the V-22, reducing man-hours from 250 hours to under 100, more than 60% reduction in labor time
Trained junior technicians on harness routing and wiring installation standards
APU jet engine run qualified, refueling qualified, and towing qualified

United States Air Force
Aircraft Electrician
2003 - 2009 (6 years)

Aircraft Electrical & Environmental Systems Craftsman on MH-53 Pave Low and CV-22 Osprey special operations aircraft
Completed three combat deployments to Iraq and one deployment to Africa in support of special operations missions
Promoted to Staff Sergeant (E6), served as lead electrician on shift with NCO supervisory responsibilities over junior airmen
Held Red X certification. Authorized to inspect subordinate work and sign off aircraft as safe for flight, a designation requiring demonstrated technical mastery and command trust
APU jet engine run certified
AF Outstanding Unit Award with Valor Device: Unit-level recognition for actions in direct combat or hostile conditions
Airman Leadership School Graduate
Honorable discharge after 6 years active duty

Education

Ohio University

USAF Technical School